

Disciplinary Procedure (2024)

Approved by the Management Committee on 2 May 2024. Applicable from 1 June 2024.

1. Principles

Sanctions must be proportionate, consistent and documented. The procedure applies alongside the work regulations (chapter 6) and the law.

2. Gradual sanctions

1. Verbal reminder (recorded in the HR file).
2. Written warning.
3. Final written warning.
4. Dismissal with notice.
5. Dismissal for serious cause (exceptional, see section 4).

3. Hearing

Before any written warning or dismissal, the employee is invited to a hearing **with at least 48 hours' notice**, stating the facts. The employee may be assisted by a union delegate or a colleague. Minutes are written and offered for signature.

4. Serious cause

4.1 A dismissal for serious cause must be notified **within three working days** from the moment the person competent to dismiss (HR Director or CEO) has sufficient certainty of the facts to form a conviction. The reasons must be notified by registered letter within three working days after the dismissal.

4.2 An internal investigation may be carried out to establish the facts, but it must be **conducted promptly and without interruption** (target: 5 working days). Delaying the decision for reasons unrelated to establishing the facts is not allowed.

4.3 Legal Counsel must be consulted before any dismissal for serious cause.

5. Records

All sanctions are kept in the personnel file for 3 years.

Catherine Lemaire, HR Director